NEXUS × SVNIT SURAT

NEXUS

SVNIT SURAT

PARTICIPANT RULEBOOK

30 October – 1 November 2026

UNCHARTED 2026



IN COLLABORATION WITH

MongoDB. | n8n

30 OCTOBER • 31 OCTOBER • 1 NOVEMBER

BUILD BOLDLY. COLLABORATE FAIRLY. MAKE YOUR WORK COUNT.

01 Welcome to Uncharted

Welcome to UNCHARTED 2026, a 24-hour online hackathon organized by NEXUS — Official DoCSE & DoAI Cell, SVNIT Surat.

Students from all SVNIT departments and academic years are invited to build a solution to the problem statement released after the workshop.

The online build phase will be followed by a shortlist of the Top 16 teams, who will present their projects in person on 1 November 2026. This rulebook outlines eligibility, development rules, submission requirements, code freeze, evaluation, and conduct.

02 Event at a Glance

DETAIL	INFORMATION
Organizer	NEXUS — Official DoCSE & DoAI Cell, SVNIT Surat
Eligibility	SVNIT students from all departments and all academic years.
Team size	Exactly 3 members per team.
Workshop	30 October 2026, 4:00–6:00 PM; MongoDB hands-on workshop at LT1, 3rd Floor.
PS forms	Released at 6:00 PM after the workshop.
Build phase	Online: 30 October, 9:00 PM – 31 October, 9:00 PM IST.
Problem statement	Assigned at exactly 9:00 PM on 30 October; coding begins immediately.
Submission form	Released at 9:00 PM on 31 October; must be completed by 10:00 PM IST.
Finals	1 November 2026; details will be communicated to shortlisted teams.
Shortlist	Top 16 teams advance to final presentations.
Presentation	10-minute presentation + 2-minute Q&A.
Prize pool	₹20,000 total prize pool.
Collaboration	In collaboration with MongoDB and n8n.

03 Timeline

DATE / TIME	MILESTONE	DETAILS
30 Oct · 4–6 PM	MongoDB Workshop	Hands-on workshop at LT1, 3rd Floor.
30 Oct · 6 PM	PS forms released	Forms released after the workshop.
30 Oct · 9 PM	Build begins	Problem statement assigned sharply at 9 PM; coding starts immediately.
31 Oct · 9 PM	Submission form released	Official submission form becomes available.
31 Oct · 10 PM	Submission deadline	All required form fields and materials must be submitted by 10 PM.
After submission	Evaluation	Submissions reviewed and Top 16 teams selected.
1 Nov	Final presentations	Details will be shared with shortlisted teams.

All times are Indian Standard Time (IST). Any schedule update will be communicated through official event channels.

04 Eligibility & Team Formation

- Participation is open only to currently enrolled SVNIT students, across all departments and academic years.
- Each team must have exactly three members. Each participant may register with only one team.
- Teams must provide accurate registration details and nominate one primary contact for official communication.
- Team changes after registration closes require approval from the organizing team.
- Organizers may request proof of student status to verify eligibility.

05 Project Development Rules

- Projects must be built within the official 24-hour window: 30 October, 9:00 PM to 31 October, 9:00 PM IST.
- Teams must follow the problem statement assigned at 9:00 PM and any additional constraints announced by organizers.
- Teams may use programming languages, frameworks, libraries, APIs, and development tools, subject to their licences, terms, and event rules.
- Pre-existing code, templates, datasets, and third-party assets must be disclosed if requested. Teams must not claim others' work as their own.
- AI coding assistants may be used only in accordance with any AI-use policy announced by the organizers. Teams remain responsible for understanding and testing their implementation.
- Do not expose API keys, passwords, secrets, or private user data in public repositories, presentations, or demo videos. Malicious code and unlawful service use are prohibited.
- Any specific requirement to use MongoDB and/or n8n will be communicated by the organizers. Do not assume a tool is mandatory unless explicitly stated.

Originality and attribution

Teams must have permission to use all code, datasets, images, fonts, models, and other assets included in their projects. Attribute third-party components where appropriate. Plagiarism or false authorship claims may result in disqualification.

06 Mandatory Submission Requirements

All teams must submit through the official form released by the organizers. The form's deadline and instructions are authoritative.

ITEM	REQUIREMENT
Team details	Team name and details for all three members.
Project overview	Project title, problem, solution summary, and main features.
Live deployment	A working, accessible URL that allows judges to test core functionality. Deployment is compulsory.
GitHub repository	Accessible repository containing the submitted code and a clear README.
Demo video	A video of maximum 7 minutes explaining the project and demonstrating key functionality.
Presentation deck	PPT covering the problem, solution, implementation, technology choices, and impact.
Access instructions	Test credentials or access steps if login is required. Never share personal passwords.

07 Submission Rules

- The official submission form will be released at 9:00 PM on 31 October 2026 and must be completed by 10:00 PM IST.
- Submit all required materials before the deadline and closing time stated in the official form.
- Teams are responsible for confirming successful form submission and checking that every link works.
- The deployed app, GitHub repository, demo video, and PPT must be accessible to judges.
- A video of a locally running project does not replace the compulsory live deployment.
- Late, incomplete, or inaccessible submissions may be penalized or deemed ineligible under the published rules.

08 Code Freeze & Post-Submission Restrictions

After the official submission deadline, the submitted project is frozen. The version submitted by the deadline is the version evaluated for shortlisting and finals.

ACTIVITY AFTER DEADLINE	RULE
Adding features or changing functionality	Prohibited.
Fixing bugs in source code	Prohibited unless organizers explicitly authorize an exception.
Pushing GitHub commits	Prohibited. No new code commits after the deadline.
Changing the deployed app	Prohibited if it changes the submitted code or functionality.
Editing the submitted video or PPT	Prohibited unless organizers request a correction.
Preparing for the final presentation	Allowed, provided the submitted project itself is not modified.
Deployment outage	Notify organizers immediately and follow the published recovery instructions.

Verification and penalties

Organizers may review repository history, submission timestamps, deployment behaviour, and relevant evidence when investigating suspected violations. Any policy for automated commits or infrastructure-generated changes should be clarified by the organizers before the build begins.

Unauthorized post-deadline development or commits may lead to score deductions, invalidation of the submission, removal from the Top 16 shortlist, or disqualification, depending on severity and intent. Organizers may ask a team to clarify disputed evidence.

09 Round 1 — Top 16 Shortlisting

Eligible submissions will be evaluated using the deployed project, repository, demo video, and PPT. The weights below are the proposed rubric for the event and should be confirmed by the organizers before publication.

CRITERION	WEIGHT	WHAT JUDGES ASSESS
Innovation & originality	20%	Creativity and distinctiveness of the idea or approach.
Technical implementation	25%	Engineering quality, architecture, and implementation depth.
Functionality & deployment	25%	Working features, usability, reliability, and accessible deployment.
Problem relevance & impact	20%	Fit to the problem statement and practical usefulness.
Demo & documentation	10%	Clear demo, PPT, README, and documentation.

10 Round 2 — Final Presentation

The Top 16 teams will present in person on 1 November 2026. Venue, reporting time, presentation order, and attendance requirements will be communicated to the shortlisted teams later.

SEGMENT	TIME	GUIDANCE
Presentation	10 minutes	Explain the problem, solution, implementation, key features, and impact. Confirm with organizers whether demo time is included.
Judges' Q&A	2 minutes	Answer questions about architecture, code, technology choices, limitations, and contributions.
Total	12 minutes	Follow the timekeeper's instructions.

11 Code of Conduct

- Treat participants, organizers, mentors, judges, and volunteers respectfully.
- Harassment, discrimination, intimidation, threats, and abusive behaviour are prohibited.
- Do not spam official channels, disrupt the event, or interfere with other teams.
- Follow official announcements, schedules, and instructions.
- Report misconduct or suspected violations privately to the organizing team.

12 Fair Play & Disqualification

Violations include plagiarism, false eligibility information, deliberate misrepresentation of functionality, manipulation of submissions or judging, unauthorized post-deadline development, and serious or repeated conduct violations. Consequences may include a warning, score deduction, invalidation of the submission, removal from the Top 16, or disqualification. Penalties should be proportionate to the violation.

13 Intellectual Property & Publicity

- Teams retain ownership of original work they create, subject to third-party licences and applicable law.
- Teams must have permission to use third-party code, datasets, images, fonts, music, models, and other assets, and provide attribution where required.
- Project showcases, participant photographs, videos, and testimonials should follow the event's stated publicity and consent process.
- Never expose API keys, passwords, private user data, or secrets in public repositories or demo videos.

14 Prizes

The announced total prize pool is ₹20,000. Prize categories, distribution, eligibility conditions, verification requirements, and disbursement timeline will be announced by the organizing team. Do not assume equal distribution unless stated explicitly.

15 Quick FAQ

QUESTION	ANSWER
Who can participate?	SVNIT students from all departments and academic years.
What is the team size?	Exactly three members.
Is deployment compulsory?	Yes. The project must be deployed and accessible to judges.
What do we submit?	Deployment URL, GitHub repository, demo video of maximum 7 minutes, PPT, and all required form fields.
When do PS forms release?	At 6:00 PM on 30 October, after the workshop.
When does coding start?	At exactly 9:00 PM on 30 October, immediately after the problem statement is assigned.
When is the submission form released?	At 9:00 PM on 31 October; it must be completed by 10:00 PM.
How many teams reach finals?	Top 16 teams.
Can we commit after submission?	No. The code-freeze policy applies after the official deadline, except for explicitly authorized exceptions.
When are finals?	1 November 2026; details will be communicated to shortlisted teams.
How long is the final presentation?	10 minutes, followed by 2 minutes of Q&A.

16 Final Submission Checklist

Before you submit, make sure every item below is complete.

○	Our team has exactly three eligible SVNIT student members.
○	Our project follows the released problem statement and event rules.
○	The project is deployed and its core functionality works.
○	The GitHub repository is correct and accessible to judges.
○	The README explains the project, setup, and key technologies.
○	The demo video is no longer than 7 minutes and clearly demonstrates the project.
○	The PPT is complete and accurately reflects the submitted project.
○	Access instructions or test credentials are provided if needed.
○	All required fields in the official submission form are complete.
○	We have submitted by 10:00 PM on 31 October and checked that all links work.
○	We understand that code, deployment, and submitted materials cannot be changed after the deadline unless explicitly authorized.

OFFICIAL COMMUNICATION

Submission form: Released by organizers at 9:00 PM on 31 October 2026.

Schedule and updates: Official event WhatsApp group.

Support contact: To be announced by organizers.

Thank you for being part of UNCHARTED 2026. Build boldly, collaborate fairly, and make your work count.